T. King wrote to Hillary Clinton to say that I was at the head of a ‘terrorist organisation’ and should be treated as such – the same Peter King that used to shake his little collection tin up and down the streets of New York City raising money for the IRA, the self styled ‘Ollie North of Ireland’. It amazed me to think about how these guardians against ‘offences’ were themselves so offensive. I read the document and realised again that I was, no matter what they said of me or invented about me, merely a figure in something much larger than myself. I could only keep my head clear, absorb the flak and the caricaturing of my nature and my motives, and continue working.

Letters arrived, and I sent some, too, but always with difficulty, as the bureaucratic machine ground on. A jail is like an island, on which the inmates can seem unreachable; it is also a concrete, living idea of abusive power, and the letters helped me to feel cared for during those difficult days in Wandsworth. The letters showed another country from this England of slopping out, where people realised that they themselves must embody the arguments for their own liberty. From Hampshire: ‘Dear Julian, You will not know me. I am just one of millions of citizens around the world who know what is going on, and are not blinded to the political games of which you have become a victim.’ From Tulse Hill: ‘You must always remember that the achievement of WikiLeaks is vital for the development of our world. P.S. Sending a puzzle book to keep you thinking.’ From Basingstoke: ‘I support your stand and feel you are being victimised and harassed by powerful forces.’ From Yorkshire: ‘Can you hear the sound of falling masonry? Keep up the good work. You are welcome in North Yorkshire any time. Excellent broadband in this part of the world, too.’ From Essex: ‘I think your case has made many people sit up and think a little more deeply about power, politics and corruption.’ From Merseyside: ‘We thought about you last night and hoped you were safe in that unpleasant place. When you are released, can you come up to the North West and explain to people the importance of freedom of thought, speech and information?’

Some of the mail came in the form of Christmas cards, simply signed ‘An Old Lady’, or ‘A Friend’. Perhaps less friendly, though delivered around the same time, was a cutting from the *Washington Times*, ‘Assassinate Assange?’ The author of this alliterative pleasantry, one Jeffrey T. Kuhner, placed a chill on the warm cards. ‘Mr Assange is not a